He thinks that individual cognitions in a mental series (*samtana*) are aware of themselves. An awareness is simultaneously and in virtue of the same act self-cognised, just as a lamp illuminates itself while illuminating an object. This tenet of the reflexivity of consciousness is central to the idealist outlook: it shows that an idea can be the object of another idea and that there is no need to posit physical objects as the causes of our thoughts.

Vasubandhu wrote the *Abhidharmakosha Bhashya*, which is a critical survey from a ***Sautrantika*** point of view of Buddhist realist schools. Other works include: the *Karmasiddhiprakarana*, which is a ***Sautrantika*** critique of realist notions of how ***karma*** works and an attempt to reconcile atomistic impersonality with moral responsibility and consequentiality; the *Madhyantavibhagashastra* (idealist); the *Trisvabhavanirdesha* (idealist); the *Vimshatika* and the *Trimshika* (idealist).

Further reading: Anacker 1984; Matilal 1986; Pruden 1988; Ram-Prasad 2002; Stcherbatsky 1970; Wood 1991

Veda: the *Rig*, *Sama*, *Yajur* and *Atharva* Vedas are regarded by mainstream orthodox Hindus as an authorless (*apaurusheya*), timeless and infallible repository of all knowledge. Their meanings are obscure and open to interpretation. The various orally transmitted Vedic traditions are held to be the only source of our knowledge about social and religious duty in accordance with the natural universal order (***dharma***). The ***Purva Mimamsa*** theorists of ritual say that ***dharma*** is that which is indicated by Vedic ritual prescriptions (*vidhi*).

The *Vedas* were held to have been received and promulgated by seven primordial 'seers' (*rishi*). The tradition was orally preserved by priestly Brahmin families maintaining particular traditions. The basic component of each of the four *Vedas* is its collection (*Samhita*) of verses (*mantra*),